

KANNAN APPIYA SANTHARAM

Senior Lead Software Engineer (Frontend/Full Stack) | React · TypeScript · Node.js · AI-Native

Chennai, India

+91 97902 47499 | as.kannan4@gmail.com | kannan-ai-dev.vercel.app/ind | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#)

Nationality: Indian | **Notice Period:** 60 Days

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Full Stack Senior Lead Software Engineer with 10.5+ years in enterprise SaaS, working across React, TypeScript, and Node.js. Currently leading an engineering team on a platform serving 4,000+ MSP and IT enterprise customers, driving technical direction across AI-native engineering with LLM orchestration, MCP servers, and production agent skills. Seeking a Senior Lead / Staff Engineer or Engineering Manager role.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- **AI test-authoring platform** that generates, runs, and self-heals end-to-end suites, reducing manual QA effort.
- **Headless Base UI design system** with customised design tokens and a custom AI agent that generates production components from a Figma link, reducing page development from 2 days to a few hours.
- **96% faster builds**, from 2 minutes to 5 seconds across 12 packages, saving hundreds of engineering hours a month.
- **70% faster initial page load**, 5 seconds down to 1.5 seconds through route-level code splitting, React lazy loading, and per-package bundle chunking.
- **4,000+ enterprise customers** served through platform-wide migrations, technical debt reduction, and regression automation delivered without disrupting the platform.
- **Mentored 10+ engineers** across SuperOps and Freshworks, reducing onboarding ramp-up time.

SKILLS

Full Stack Engineering: React, TypeScript, JavaScript (ES6+), Responsive Web Design, Node.js, MySQL, Python, REST API Design & Integration, GraphQL & Apollo, Zustand, Jest & Vitest, Playwright, Jenkins CI/CD, Docker, AWS

Leadership & Delivery: Engineering Team Leadership, Solution Architecture & System Design, Developer Mentorship (10+ engineers), Architecture & Code Reviews, Agile & Scrum Delivery, Cross-Team Collaboration, Stakeholder Management & Customer Communication

AI-Native Engineering: Production Agent Skills, Model Context Protocol (MCP) Servers, LLM Orchestration, AI Agent Guardrails & Safety, RAG & Embedding, Amazon Bedrock AgentCore

Platform & Performance: Monorepos, Module Federation, Rspack & Webpack 5, Micro-Frontends, Design Systems & UI SDKs, Performance Optimisation & Core Web Vitals

Tools: Claude Code, Cursor, GitHub Copilot, Figma, Knip Static Analysis, Git & GitHub Flow

WORK EXPERIENCE

SUPEROPS

Senior Lead Software Engineer

Chennai, India

Jul 2022 – Present

Progression: Senior Software Engineer › Lead Software Engineer › Senior Lead Software Engineer

- Ship major product features end-to-end in React and TypeScript as a hands-on contributor, delivering high-quality software on schedule with product managers and UI/UX designers.
- Lead and manage a frontend team of 4 to 6 engineers on a platform serving 4,000+ MSP and IT enterprise customers, owning sprint planning, architecture reviews, hiring and interviews, performance feedback and career development, and roadmap prioritisation with product managers.
- Reduced build time by 96%, from 2 minutes to 5 seconds, through a solo Webpack 5 to Rspack migration delivered in 3 weeks across 12 monorepo packages, saving hundreds of engineering hours per month and accelerating time-to-market for every downstream feature.
- Reduced manual regression effort and release risk by architecting an AI test-authoring platform in React and Node.js that orchestrates LLM agents to generate, execute, and self-heal end-to-end test suites over

HTTP Web Streams, backed by a 300+ test-case Playwright regression suite in Jenkins CI/CD.

- Improved developer productivity by integrating custom Claude Code skills and MCP servers into the production development workflow, with multi-tier write-scope guardrails that let engineers run autonomous agents safely, and built a Python MCP server exposing the frontend codebase as a queryable graph, now used by AI tooling across multiple engineering teams.
- Built a headless Base UI design system on customised design tokens and a Claude Code skill that generates production components from a Figma node link via MCP, reducing page development from 2 days to a few hours, alongside a reusable UI SDK framework and architectural standards adopted across product teams.
- Optimised application performance through route-level code splitting, React lazy loading (Suspense), and per-package bundle chunking, and removed dead code and unused dependencies to reduce technical debt and the build and security surface.
- Delivered enterprise features including role-based access control (RBAC) and near-real-time operational dashboards, tuning custom cached Apollo hooks to balance data freshness against network load.

FRESHWORKS

Senior Software Engineer (Customer-Facing Engineering)

Chennai, India

Jun 2018 – Jul 2022

Progression: Onboarding Engineer > Senior Software Engineer

- Acted as the technical point of contact for enterprise customers, partnering with Support, Customer Success, and Sales to turn complex account requirements into solutions that unblocked onboarding and renewals.
- Reduced support handling effort by building a Customer 360 dashboard consolidating support, sales, and account data into a single operational view.
- Integrated tier-1 SaaS systems including Jira, Salesforce, Zendesk, and ServiceNow through REST API services, expanding platform fit in enterprise deals.
- Delivered reusable add-ons and supporting REST API services to meet customer-specific requirements without one-off custom development.
- Mentored 6 to 7 junior and onboarding engineers on React, REST API development, and UI architecture through structured code and design reviews, accelerating team onboarding.
- Developed features end-to-end across Freshworks products, building the React UI with the Node.js REST API services and MySQL data layer behind it, delivering enterprise requirements without depending on a separate backend team.

NICHE VIDEO MEDIA, LLC / INFIGENIC, LLC (ACQUIRED BY FRESHWORKS)

Software Developer

Chennai & Bengaluru, India | Mar 2016 – Jun 2018

Progression: Web Application Developer & Designer > Software Developer

- Built an admin dashboard that dynamically priced Stripe plans across feature selection, storage tiers, and bandwidth limits, increasing self-serve revenue.
- Built video player customisation from scratch with configurable controls, annotations, and call-to-action overlays, increasing viewer conversion.
- Built responsive, high-converting company and product landing pages in HTML5, CSS3, and JavaScript.
- Integrated Freshservice with DocuSign over REST API services to extend enterprise workflow coverage, joining Freshworks with the team on acquisition.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Engineering (B.E.), Computer Science

2011 – 2015

K.L.N. College of Information Technology (Affiliated with Anna University), Tamil Nadu, India

LANGUAGES

English: Fluent (Professional Working Proficiency) | **Tamil:** Native | **Hindi:** Intermediate